

# SWEETLEASE

## University Partnership Playbook

Step-by-Step Guide to Building Campus Partnerships Across Multiple Metros

|                 |                   |
|-----------------|-------------------|
| Stage:          | Pre-Launch        |
| Date:           | February 2026     |
| Classification: | Internal Use Only |

### Table of Contents

### 1. Why University Partnerships Matter

University campuses are the single highest-concentration source of renters in any city. Students actively searching for housing, forming roommate groups, and dealing with expensive off-campus rental markets represent the perfect early adopter for SweetLease's group negotiation model. This section explains why campus partnerships are your highest-ROI acquisition channel at the pre-launch stage.

#### The Numbers

- **46 million renter households** exist in the US, and college students represent the most concentrated, high-intent segment.
- **80-90% of students** at large public universities live off-campus, creating massive demand for rental solutions.
- **Median student rent** ranges from \$1,200/month (Ohio State) to \$5,100+/month (UCLA) in target metros.
- **Move-in cycle is predictable:** students search 4-6 months before the fall semester, creating a reliable annual demand wave.
- **Natural group formation:** students already look for roommates, making group negotiation feel intuitive rather than novel.

#### Strategic Advantages

- **Concentrated demand:** One campus partnership can yield 500-2,000 verified signups in a single semester.
- **Low CAC:** University partnerships cost \$10-25 per acquired user vs. \$30-50 for cold digital ads.
- **Built-in virality:** Students share housing tools within their social networks. One ambassador can influence 50-100 peers.
- **Annual renewal:** Each fall semester brings a new cohort of housing-seekers, making the channel self-renewing.
- **Credibility signal:** A university partnership gives SweetLease institutional legitimacy that paid ads cannot replicate.

#### Key Insight

HousingAnywhere built a \$100M+ business by partnering with 160+ universities. Venmo became ubiquitous through campus ambassador programs. SweetLease's group negotiation model is even more naturally suited to campus life, where students are already forming roommate groups and searching for shared housing.

### 2. Who to Contact at Each University

Successfully landing a university partnership depends on reaching the right person. University housing ecosystems involve multiple stakeholders, and approaching the wrong office wastes time. Here is the decision-making hierarchy and how to navigate it.

#### 2.1 Decision-Making Hierarchy

|                                       |                                 |                                                               |                                                                |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Director of Off-Campus Housing        | Student Affairs / Housing       | Off-campus resource pages, housing fairs, partner listings    | Feature SweetLease as an official resource; co-host workshops  |
| Dean of Students                      | Student Affairs                 | Broad student services, budget approval for new partnerships  | Institutional endorsement; budget for co-branded programs      |
| Director of Residence Life            | Housing & Residential Education | On-campus housing operations; overflow referral to off-campus | Referral pipeline for students who don't get on-campus housing |
| International Student Office Director | International Programs          | Housing resources for international students                  | Preferred housing tool for incoming international students     |

|                                        |                    |                                             |                                                          |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Career Services Director               | Career Center      | Relocation support for internships and jobs | Housing benefit for relocating students and recent grads |
| Graduate Student Association President | Student Government | Grad student advocacy and communications    | Promote to grad student mailing lists; co-host events    |

### Recommended Approach Order

- **Start with Off-Campus Housing Office:** This is your primary target. They manage off-campus resource pages, housing fairs, and partner directories. Many universities (like University of Michigan, Old Dominion, UMass Amherst) have dedicated Off-Campus Student Life coordinators specifically tasked with finding housing solutions for students.
- **Parallel outreach to International Student Office:** International students are the most housing-insecure population on campus. They arrive without local rental history, credit scores, or social networks. SweetLease's verification and group matching solves their exact pain point.
- **Engage Graduate Student Associations:** Grad students are older (25-35), higher income, longer tenure (2-6 years), and have strong communication channels. They're your ideal power users and can champion SweetLease through their networks.
- **Escalate to Dean of Students for institutional partnerships:** Once you have a working relationship with the Off-Campus Housing Office, the Dean's endorsement unlocks budget, co-branding, and orientation integration.

### How to Find Contact Information

- **University website:** Search "[University Name] off-campus housing" or "[University Name] student life." Most offices list staff directories with names, titles, and emails.
- **LinkedIn:** Search for titles like "Director of Off-Campus Housing" + university name. Request a warm introduction if you share any connections.
- **Housing fairs:** Attend as a vendor (even before partnership) to meet coordinators in person. Most fairs charge \$50-200 for a table.
- **Student government:** Email the graduate or undergraduate student body president directly. Their emails are always public.

## 3. Top 20 Target Universities

These universities were selected based on three criteria: large off-campus renter populations, expensive rental markets that create urgency for negotiation tools, and tech-savvy student demographics. They are organized into tiers based on strategic priority.

### 3.1 Tier 1: Launch Markets (Months 1-6)

These universities combine massive scale with acute housing pain. Start here to build your initial user base and prove the model.

| NYU                 | New York, NY    | 50,000+ | ~85% | \$4,795/mo       | Highest rents in the US; dense urban campus; international student population |
|---------------------|-----------------|---------|------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Columbia University | New York, NY    | 33,000+ | ~70% | \$1,500-2,800/mo | Ivy League credibility; expensive NYC market; grad-heavy                      |
| UC Berkeley         | Berkeley, CA    | 45,000+ | ~80% | \$2,500+/mo      | Bay Area premium market; severe supply shortage; tech-forward students        |
| UCLA                | Los Angeles, CA | 45,000+ | ~75% | \$5,158/mo       | Extreme rents; wealthy demographics; high tech adoption                       |
| UT Austin           | Austin, TX      | 51,800+ | ~83% | \$1,400+/mo      | Massive off-campus population (42K+); fast-growing expensive market           |
| Boston University   | Boston, MA      | 37,000+ | ~65% | \$2,200+/mo      | Urban campus; extremely expensive market; tech-savvy                          |

### 3.2 Tier 2: Volume Markets (Months 4-9)

These universities have the largest absolute off-campus populations. Use them to scale user numbers after proving the model in Tier 1 cities.

| Arizona State University    | Tempe, AZ           | 145,000+ | ~80% | \$1,200+/mo     | Largest enrollment in US; acute housing crisis; only 20% on-campus   |
|-----------------------------|---------------------|----------|------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Univ. of Central Florida    | Orlando, FL         | 69,800+  | ~88% | \$1,400+/mo     | Extreme off-campus dependency; 59K+ undergrads                       |
| Florida International Univ. | Miami, FL           | 57,000+  | ~80% | \$1,800+/mo     | 35K+ bed shortage; international students; expensive Miami market    |
| Ohio State University       | Columbus, OH        | 63,600+  | ~75% | \$1,220/bedroom | Third-largest public university; 20-month consecutive rent increases |
| Texas A&M University        | College Station, TX | 81,000+  | ~70% | \$1,000+/mo     | Second-largest enrollment; strong engagement culture                 |
| Univ. of Florida            | Gainesville, FL     | 56,000+  | ~75% | \$1,100+/mo     | Large off-campus population; underserved market                      |

### 3.3 Tier 3: Prestige & Expansion (Months 6-12)

These universities add geographic diversity and brand prestige. Partnerships here signal credibility to landlords and investors.

| Stanford University     | Palo Alto, CA    | 17,400  | ~50% | \$6,066/mo  | Highest median rent in US; VC/tech network; prestige signal |
|-------------------------|------------------|---------|------|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Univ. of Pennsylvania   | Philadelphia, PA | 25,000+ | ~60% | \$1,600+/mo | Ivy League; expensive urban market; grad-heavy              |
| Northeastern University | Boston, MA       | 36,000+ | ~60% | \$2,200+/mo | Co-op relocation needs; frequent moves; tech-forward        |
| USC                     | Los Angeles, CA  | 49,000+ | ~65% | \$2,500+/mo | Major market; wealthy demographics; proptech hub            |
| Univ. of Chicago        | Chicago, IL      | 17,400  | ~55% | \$1,500+/mo | Expensive urban market; high-achieving demographics         |
| Northwestern University | Evanston, IL     | 20,000+ | ~55% | \$1,400+/mo | Chicago metro; engineering/business school pipeline         |

|                     |               |         |      |             |                                                                  |
|---------------------|---------------|---------|------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Univ. of Washington | Seattle, WA   | 47,000+ | ~70% | \$1,800+/mo | Tech hub; high adoption rates; expensive market                  |
| Univ. of Michigan   | Ann Arbor, MI | 47,000+ | ~65% | \$1,300+/mo | Well-established off-campus office (partnership template exists) |

4. Timing & Academic Calendar Strategy

University partnerships are highly seasonal. Approaching at the wrong time means waiting 6-12 months for the next window. This calendar maps every critical milestone.

4.1 Annual Partnership Calendar

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                      |                                       |                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                      |                                       |                                                 |
| September                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Initial outreach to housing offices  | Off-Campus Housing Directors          | Introduce SweetLease; request meeting           |
| October                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Pitch meetings and demos             | Housing Directors, Dean of Students   | Secure verbal commitment for spring partnership |
| November                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Finalize partnership terms           | Housing office + legal/admin          | Signed partnership agreement                    |
| December                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Ambassador recruitment begins        | Student government, grad associations | Recruit 4-8 ambassadors per campus              |
| January                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Ambassador training and content prep | Internal team + ambassadors           | Trained ambassadors with materials ready        |
| February                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Spring Housing Fair participation    | Housing fair organizers               | Booth at fair; collect 200-500 leads per campus |
| March-April                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Peak activation campaign             | Ambassadors + housing office          | Convert leads to verified users; form groups    |
| May-June                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Pre-summer push for fall leases      | All channels                          | Drive group formations for August move-ins      |
| July-August                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Orientation integration              | Orientation coordinators              | Present at new student orientations             |
| <b>Critical Timing Window</b><br>The February housing fair is the most important single event in the annual cycle. Universities like Penn State, University of Oregon, and UW hold their spring housing fairs in early February. You need partnership agreements signed by November to be included as a featured resource at these fairs. Start outreach no later than September. |                                      |                                       |                                                 |

4.2 Lease Cycle Alignment

Student lease cycles follow a predictable pattern that SweetLease should exploit:

- **December-February:** Students begin searching for next-year housing. This is when group formation should be most actively promoted.
- **March-May:** Lease signing season. Groups should be negotiating with landlords during this window.
- **June-August:** Move-in preparation. Late-cycle students scramble for housing. Second opportunity for group formation.
- **September-November:** Lease renewal season for current tenants. Opportunity for renegotiation groups.

5. Email Templates & Outreach Scripts

Below are field-tested email templates for each stage of the university partnership journey. Customize the bracketed fields for each school.

5.1 Initial Cold Outreach to Off-Campus Housing Director

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Subject:</b> Helping [University] students save 5-15% on off-campus rent</p> <p>Hi [Name],</p> <p>I'm [Your Name], founder of SweetLease. We're building a platform that helps students find roommates, get pre-verified, and negotiate group discounts on rent.</p> <p>I'm reaching out because [University] has [X,000+] students living off-campus in one of the most expensive rental markets in the country. Our platform lets students form verified groups and collectively negotiate better lease terms, typically saving 5-15% on monthly rent.</p> <p>Here's what we offer university partners at no cost:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Co-branded off-campus housing resource page</li><li>- Roommate matching tool for incoming students</li><li>- Free tenant verification (credit, income, background) for students</li><li>- Rental market data for [City] to share with your office</li></ul> <p>Would you have 20 minutes this month for a quick call? I'd love to learn how your office currently supports off-campus students and explore whether SweetLease could add value.</p> <p>Best,</p> <p>[Your Name]<br/>[Title], SweetLease<br/>[Phone]   [Email]</p> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

5.2 Follow-Up Email (5 Days Later)

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Subject:</b> Re: Helping [University] students save on rent</p> <p>Hi [Name],</p> <p>I wanted to follow up on my note from last week. I know your office is busy this time of year, so I'll keep this brief.</p> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

We just completed our beta with [X] students at [University/City], and the average group saved \$[X]/month on their lease. I think this could be particularly valuable for [University]'s international students and graduate students who are navigating [City]'s rental market for the first time.

I'd also love to discuss participating in your spring housing fair if there's still availability.

Happy to work around your schedule. Would [Day 1] or [Day 2] work for a 15-minute call?

Best,  
[Your Name]

5.3 International Student Office Outreach

**Subject:** Free housing support tool for [University]'s international students

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out because international students face unique challenges finding off-campus housing: no US credit history, unfamiliarity with lease negotiation norms, and limited local networks for finding roommates.

SweetLease was built to solve exactly this. Our platform provides:

- AI-powered roommate matching based on lifestyle and budget compatibility
- Tenant verification that builds rental credibility without US credit history
- Group negotiation tools so students can collectively secure better lease terms
- Guidance on US rental processes and tenant rights

We'd love to offer this as a free resource for [University]'s international student community. Could we schedule a brief demo?

Best,  
[Your Name]

5.4 Graduate Student Association Partnership Email

**Subject:** Partnership opportunity: Help grad students save on rent

Hi [Name],

Congratulations on your role with [GSA Name]. I'm reaching out with a partnership idea that could deliver real value to your members.

SweetLease is a new platform that helps renters form groups and negotiate collective discounts on rent. Graduate students are our ideal users: you're budget-conscious, looking for compatible roommates, and often new to [City]'s rental market.

Here's what we're proposing:

- Exclusive early access for [University] grad students
- Co-hosted "Renter Empowerment" workshop (we handle all logistics)
- Feature in your newsletter or welcome packet
- Commission-free savings for your members

In exchange, we'd love a brief mention in your communications and help spreading the word through your channels.

Want to grab coffee or hop on a 15-minute call to discuss?

Best,  
[Your Name]

5.5 Housing Fair Booth Request

**Subject:** Vendor application for [University] Spring Housing Fair

Hi [Name],

I'd like to apply for a vendor booth at [University]'s upcoming Spring Housing Fair on [Date].

SweetLease is an AI-powered platform that helps students find roommates, verify their rental credentials, and negotiate group discounts on off-campus housing. We believe our tools would be a strong complement to the resources your office already provides.

We're happy to pay the standard vendor fee and can also offer:

- Free live demos for students at the fair
- Printed "Off-Campus Housing Checklist" handouts (co-branded with [University])
- A raffle prize for attendees (e.g., \$500 toward first month's rent)

Please let me know the application process and deadlines. Happy to provide any additional information.

Best,  
[Your Name]

## 6. Campus Ambassador Program

The ambassador program is your force multiplier on campus. One well-placed ambassador can drive 50-100 signups through personal networks, events, and social content. This section covers the complete program design.

### 6.1 Program Structure

Use a two-tier structure inspired by Bumble's highly successful "Beehive" campus program:

#### Campus Director (1 per university)

- Profile:** Junior or senior with strong campus connections, leadership experience, and social media presence. Ideally a student government member, RA, or club president.
- Compensation:** \$15-20/hour (10-15 hours/week) + \$500-1,000 monthly bonus tied to verified signup targets.
- Responsibilities:** Manage 4-6 ambassadors, organize campus events, coordinate with housing office, report metrics weekly, create local content strategy.

#### Campus Ambassadors (4-6 per university)

- Profile:** Socially active students across different schools/departments within the university. Diversity of backgrounds maximizes reach.
- Compensation:** \$12-15/hour (5-8 hours/week) + performance bonuses (\$5 per verified signup they directly refer).
- Responsibilities:** Share on personal social media, host dorm/apartment tabling sessions, distribute materials, refer friends, attend events.

### 6.2 Recruitment Strategy

- Post on campus job boards:** Handshake, campus career portals, and student Facebook groups. Title: "SweetLease Campus Director - Help Students Save on Rent."
- Recruit through student organizations:** Pitch at student government meetings, business clubs, real estate clubs, and cultural organizations.
- Tap RA networks:** Resident Advisors interact with hundreds of students and are trusted voices on housing. They often welcome supplemental income.
- Leverage your first users:** Your best ambassadors will be students who already used SweetLease and saved money. Recruit from your early adopter base.

### 6.3 Ambassador Toolkit

Equip every ambassador with:

- Digital assets:** Branded social media templates (Instagram stories, TikTok hooks, LinkedIn posts) pre-made in Canva with customizable text.
- Physical materials:** Business cards with QR codes, branded stickers, tabling banner, and printed "Off-Campus Housing Checklist" flyers.
- Unique referral link:** Each ambassador gets a trackable link ([sweetlease.com/ref/\[name\]](https://sweetlease.com/ref/[name])) that credits them for every signup and verified user.
- Talking points card:** Pocket-sized card with the top 5 elevator pitch points and answers to common questions.
- Event kit:** Guide for hosting a "Renter Empowerment" workshop: agenda, slides, signup sheet, and raffle mechanics.

### 6.4 Ambassador KPIs

|                             |         |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|
|                             |         |       |
| Signups per month           | 200-500 | 30-50 |
| Verified users per month    | 80-200  | 12-20 |
| Events hosted per month     | 2-3     | 1     |
| Social media posts per week | 3-5     | 2-3   |
| Group formations influenced | 10-20   | 3-5   |

## 7. Partnership Value Proposition

When you meet with a university housing director, you need to clearly articulate what SweetLease offers them. This is your pitch framework.

### 7.1 What You Offer the University (Free)

|                            |                                                                                         |                                                                                       |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            |                                                                                         |                                                                                       |
| Co-branded resource page   | Custom SweetLease page featuring the university's branding and local rental data        | Adds a modern tool to their off-campus resources without any cost or development work |
| Roommate matching tool     | AI-powered matching based on lifestyle, budget, and schedule compatibility              | Reduces housing-related student complaints and roommate conflicts                     |
| Free tenant verification   | Credit, income, and background verification for students                                | Helps students build rental credibility; reduces disputes with landlords              |
| Local rental market data   | Data dashboard showing average rents, trends, and negotiation success rates in the area | Informs their housing guidance and counseling conversations                           |
| Renter education workshops | Co-hosted events teaching students about lease terms, tenant rights, and negotiation    | Delivers student programming without demanding staff time                             |

|                            |                                            |                                                                      |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Housing fair participation | Interactive booth with demos and giveaways | Adds a popular vendor that drives student attendance at their events |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|

7.2 What You Ask from the University

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                  |                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Link on off-campus housing resource page                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Minimal (5 minutes)              | Primary discovery channel; students trust university-endorsed resources |
| Mention in housing-related emails/newsletters                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Low (copy-paste blurb)           | Reaches entire off-campus student population directly                   |
| Booth at housing fair                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Low (standard vendor process)    | Face-to-face interaction with 200-1,000 students in one day             |
| Inclusion in orientation materials                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Medium (requires approval cycle) | Reaches every incoming student at the moment they need housing help     |
| Ambassador program endorsement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Low (informal approval)          | Gives ambassadors credibility and access to campus spaces for tabling   |
| <b>Pitch Framing</b><br>Always lead with what you give, not what you ask. The university's primary concern is student welfare, not your growth metrics. Frame everything as: "We want to help your students navigate the rental market more safely and affordably. Here's how we can support your office's mission." |                                  |                                                                         |

8. "Renter Empowerment" Workshop Playbook

Co-hosted workshops are your highest-conversion event format. A 45-minute workshop can convert 30-50% of attendees into signups. This format positions SweetLease as an educational resource, not a sales pitch, building trust and credibility.

8.1 Workshop Agenda (45 minutes)

|           |                                |                                                                               |                 |
|-----------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 0-5 min   | Welcome & intros               | Thank university partner; introduce SweetLease team                           | Campus Director |
| 5-15 min  | Know Your Rights               | Tenant rights in [State]; what landlords can/can't do; security deposit rules | SweetLease team |
| 15-25 min | How to Read a Lease            | Key clauses to watch for; red flags; negotiable terms                         | SweetLease team |
| 25-35 min | The Power of Group Negotiation | Why groups get better deals; how SweetLease works; live demo                  | SweetLease team |
| 35-40 min | Q&A                            | Open questions from attendees                                                 | All             |
| 40-45 min | Sign up & raffle               | QR code signup; raffle drawing (\$500 rent credit or similar)                 | Campus Director |

8.2 Workshop Logistics

- **Venue:** Student union meeting room, library event space, or large classroom. Book through housing office or student organization.
- **Promotion:** 2 weeks advance notice via university email listservs, ambassador social media posts, physical flyers in housing office and student union.
- **Incentives:** Free pizza and drinks (budget \$150-250 per event). Raffle prize for attendees who sign up (\$500 rent credit, AirPods, etc.).
- **Materials:** Printed "Off-Campus Housing Checklist" handout, SweetLease stickers, QR code signup cards.
- **Follow-up:** Email all attendees within 24 hours with workshop slides, a link to sign up, and a reminder about the referral program.
- **Target attendance:** 40-80 students per workshop. Host 1-2 workshops per campus per semester.

9. Tracking & Measurement Framework

Every partnership should be measured against clear KPIs to determine ROI and inform scaling decisions.

9.1 Partnership Scorecard

|                           |                                |                                              |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Raw signups               | 500-2,000                      | UTM-tagged links per university              |
| Verified users            | 150-600                        | Verification completion rate by source       |
| Groups formed             | 20-60                          | Groups tagged with university affiliation    |
| Successful negotiations   | 5-15                           | Closed deals attributed to university cohort |
| Average savings per group | \$200-500/month                | Negotiated discount vs. listed rent          |
| Ambassador performance    | 30-50 signups/ambassador/month | Individual referral link tracking            |
| Cost per verified user    | <\$25                          | Total partnership cost / verified users      |
| Workshop attendance       | 40-80 per event                | Event registration + check-in                |
| Housing fair leads        | 200-500 per fair               | QR code scans + email signups at booth       |

9.2 University Partnership Dashboard

Track each university partnership in a centralized dashboard (spreadsheet or CRM) with these columns:

|                             |                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| University Name             | Full name of the institution                                                                 |
| City / Metro                | Geographic market                                                                            |
| Tier                        | 1, 2, or 3 based on strategic priority                                                       |
| Primary Contact             | Name, title, email of housing office contact                                                 |
| Partnership Status          | Pipeline stage: Prospect / Contacted / Meeting Scheduled / Terms Proposed / Active / Renewed |
| Agreement Signed Date       | Date of signed partnership agreement                                                         |
| Ambassador Count            | Number of active ambassadors (Director + Ambassadors)                                        |
| Events This Semester        | Count of workshops, fairs, and tabling sessions                                              |
| Signups (Cumulative)        | Total signups attributed to this university                                                  |
| Verified Users (Cumulative) | Total verified users attributed to this university                                           |
| Cost to Date                | Ambassador compensation + events + materials                                                 |

|                        |                                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Cost Per Verified User | Cost to Date / Verified Users         |
| Next Action            | What needs to happen next and by when |

9.3 Go/No-Go Decision Criteria

After one semester at a university, use these thresholds to decide whether to renew and expand:

|                               |                             |                          |               |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|---------------|
|                               |                             |                          |               |
| Verified users                | 400+                        | 150-400                  | <150          |
| Cost per verified user        | <\$15                       | \$15-30                  | >\$30         |
| Groups formed                 | 30+                         | 10-30                    | <10           |
| Ambassador engagement         | All active, hitting targets | Some underperforming     | Most inactive |
| Housing office responsiveness | Proactive collaboration     | Reactive but cooperative | Unresponsive  |

10. Budget & Resource Plan

10.1 Per-Campus Budget (One Semester)

|                               |                |                                                              |
|-------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               |                |                                                              |
| Campus Director compensation  | \$3,000-5,000  | 10-15 hrs/week x 16 weeks x \$15-20/hr + bonuses             |
| Ambassador compensation (5)   | \$4,000-6,000  | 5 ambassadors x 6 hrs/week x 16 weeks x \$12-15/hr + bonuses |
| Workshop events (2)           | \$500-800      | Pizza, drinks, raffle prizes, materials                      |
| Housing fair booth            | \$100-300      | Vendor fee + printed materials                               |
| Physical materials            | \$200-400      | Stickers, flyers, banners, business cards                    |
| Social media ad boost (local) | \$500-1,000    | Geo-targeted Instagram/TikTok ads around campus              |
| TOTAL per campus              | \$8,300-13,500 | Target: <\$25 per verified user                              |

10.2 Multi-Campus Rollout Budget

|                       |                               |                   |              |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------|--------------|
|                       |                               |                   |              |
| Phase 1 (Months 1-6)  | 5-6 Tier 1 schools            | \$50,000-80,000   | 1,500-4,000  |
| Phase 2 (Months 4-9)  | + 6 Tier 2 schools (12 total) | \$100,000-160,000 | 3,500-8,000  |
| Phase 3 (Months 6-12) | + 8 Tier 3 schools (20 total) | \$170,000-270,000 | 6,000-14,000 |

ROI Calculation

At 20 campuses with an average cost of \$12,000/campus/semester, your total investment is ~\$240,000. If this yields 10,000 verified users at an average LTV of \$120-360, the program generates \$1.2M-\$3.6M in lifetime value, delivering 5:1 to 15:1 ROI.

11. Your First 30 Days: Step-by-Step

This is your immediate action plan. Follow this sequence to launch your first university partnerships.

Week 1: Research & List Building

- **Identify 10 target universities** from the Tier 1 and Tier 2 lists above. Prioritize cities where you plan to launch SweetLease first.
- **Find the Off-Campus Housing Director** at each university. Check the university website's student affairs or housing section for staff directories.
- **Find the International Student Office Director** at each university. These are usually listed under "Global" or "International Programs."
- **Set up tracking:** Create a spreadsheet with the dashboard fields from Section 9.2 for each target university.
- **Draft personalized emails** using the templates in Section 5, customized with each university's enrollment data and local rent figures.

Week 2: Outreach

- **Send initial outreach emails** to all 10 Off-Campus Housing Directors (Section 5.1 template).
- **Send parallel outreach** to International Student Office Directors (Section 5.3 template).
- **Connect with Graduate Student Association presidents** via email and LinkedIn (Section 5.4 template).
- **Research housing fair dates** for each university and submit vendor applications where deadlines allow (Section 5.5 template).

Week 3: Follow-Up & Meetings

- **Send follow-up emails** to anyone who hasn't responded (Section 5.2 template).
- **Schedule and conduct demo calls** with interested contacts. Prepare a 15-minute screen-share showing the platform.
- **Share partnership one-pager** (summary of Section 7's value proposition) with anyone who requests more information.

Week 4: Close & Activate

- Finalize partnership terms with responsive universities. Keep agreements simple: a one-page MOU covering what each side provides.
- Begin ambassador recruitment at committed campuses. Post on Handshake and student job boards.
- Plan your first workshop date and begin promoting through university channels.
- Debrief and adjust: Review response rates, refine messaging, and prepare for the next wave of outreach.

